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SL

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Sylvain Leroux

End of Course Project Extension (/learn/advanced-data-structures/module/P9ldC/discussions) · 5 days ago (/learn/advanced-data-structures/discussions/aTEEZ68HEeWacw7zR2f1aQ) · Edited

I've just passed the course (with a perfect score. Yeah ! :))

Overall it was a great course, mostly in line with the the previous courses in the specialization.

As of myself, I particularly liked the mix of theoretical content and hand-on machine programming assignments. As there is (almost) nothing perfect in this world, a few remarks though:

- I've already said it elsewhere (https://www.coursera.org/learn/advanced-data-structures/discussions/-0VWZq7vEeWfHwqjLjBT9w), and I'm not the only one thinking like that (https://www.coursera.org/learn/advanced-data-structures/discussions/V3oQsqsyEeWRTArgYkB6yQ). A source code management system should have been introduced somewhere in the specialization. I understand this might add some overhead to the course and is somewhat off-topic speaking strictly of the course content. But for a professional-grade specialization this is a must.
- Some design (https://www.coursera.org/learn/advanced-data-structures/discussions/KOPfi62wEeWfHwqjLjBT9w) choices (https://www.coursera.org/learn/advanced-data-structures/discussions/ZjeoB620EeWHMgod_NjFNw) in the starter code are doubtful. Just like it is sometimes in the real-life. Once again, having introduced source code management using Git (for example) would have allowed the most advanced of us to submit pull request -- and for most of the students, to be exposed to notions like patching or merging the code -- which is part of the daily developer job.
- For the same reason, it was a little bit disappointed to *not* see much support for unit testing (https://www.coursera.org/learn/advanced-data-structures/discussions/8RzlvqgkEeWiXLB9mtqCw/replies/24T0mKImEeW2LwpPVHyhww) in this course. The graders were provided with the starter code, and I think many students felt like it was the "only test to pass" to ensure correctness of their code. And I was somewhat uncomfortable with that idea.
- Finally, I understand the course might appear tough to some students. But you (the "instructors") made such a good job explaining things that I assume most of us will be able to overcome the difficulties. And after all, we have the forum to gather more help if needed. With all that in mind, I think the course was a little bit too short. Maybe some more practical considerations might have been introduced in the last week. Like dealing with very large graph or persistence. Or introducing some efficient representation for very sparse matrix. Parallel algorithms would have been nice to see too. Of course, not in depth. But as an overture to the next course or pointing out some external documentation.

Please, don't take me wrong: those are only suggestions to improve the course (according to my taste !). But, as I said first, the course is already very good like it is. As a last work, I would say this was especially nice to see the instructors actually replying us on the forum. This prove your dedication to this MOOC.

I'm definitely looking forward for the next course, especially concerning "Mastering the Software Engineering Interview"-part as I am myself in a search for a new job (https://fr.linkedin.com/in/sylvain-leroux-5229a11a) (I just hope it will not start too late to be really useful to me ;).

Seasons greetings,

--Sylvain

EDIT/I forgot to thank all the students participating in the forum and the support staff (Hi, Alecl). Our discussion were always stimulating and give opportunities to dig deeper in the course material.

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SM Saleem Mirza · 3 days ago (/learn/advanced-data-structures/discussions/aTEEZ68HEeWacw7zR2f1aQ/replies/eRceKq8KEeWhLRlkesxXNw/comments/Vj_1S7DWEEwJcBKYq1ZMQ) · Edited (/learn/advanced-data-structures/profiles/659162581d1b3220d7c88c2d0a165395)

Not a perfect score (95.5), but I definitely learned alot. I was never comfortable with graphs but thanks to wonderful teaching team, they made it easy and understandable.

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MM
lma mimes · Instructor · 5 days ago (/learn/advanced-data-structures/discussions/a1e2208ee2acw7zRz1Taq/replies/nkgd-a9REeW2dA51rBQ9EW)
(/learn/advanced-data-structures/profiles/4cc929aed8e0f158f4534a4f90386d16)
Thank you for your enthusiasm and persistence! I've appreciated your forum posts and the interesting discussions that often ensued.
A bit of foreshadowing: in the next course you'll hear from a Google engineer who switched careers mid-path and talks about his strategies and challenges.
Best wishes!
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SD

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